

Political Risk Monitor - September 2026

送信者: Marília Sírío 受信日時: 2026-09-22 02:11

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Political Risk Monitor

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21 Sep 2026 13:10 EDT Read full report

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Chart of the month

Geopolitical risks are lifting yields through tighter policy expectations amid inflationary pressures and higher term premia (the extra return investors demand for holding long-term bonds given elevated uncertainty), adding to fiscal pressure. The Iran war raised near-term inflation risks, and heightened uncertainty led investors to demand a higher risk premium, even as long-run inflation expectations remain anchored; AI-related rate uncertainty is also playing a part. Rising yields are pushing up governments' debt-servicing costs almost everywhere—the clear exception being China—leaving less room to absorb future shocks as interest bills crowd out other spending. Domestic politics add to the squeeze: Recent Eurasia Group research (see: Congressional control shapes Treasury yields , 27 August 2026) shows that Treasury yields tend to rise under unified government, and November's midterms—which will decide whether Republicans keep both chambers of Congress—are therefore a key risk event for US borrowing costs.

Trends in global political stability

Geopolitical stability continued to deteriorate in August, even as markets proved resilient to shocks. The decline in the composite score was widespread, with the exception of countries such as Venezuela. The largest losses, however, were in the Economic category, as the conflict with Iran spilled over into energy prices, trade routes, and borrowing costs. Against that backdrop, Ukraine's political stability remains at historic lows, while Vietnam's is at historic highs.

Countries are ranked by level of political stability (0-100), as measured by Eurasia Group's Global Political Risk Index (GPRI). The dots represent the country's level of stability; the overlaid bar and

whisker chart summarizes the historical distribution of GPRI scores. The colored dots represent the short-term political trajectory, which predicts the impact of politics on a country's economic and investment climate over the next six months.

Trajectory updates

These maps present Eurasia Group's updated short-term (six-month) and long-term (24-month) political trajectories. In August (since the last report) and September (as of 21 September):

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Senegal: The long-term trajectory has shifted from negative to neutral. Since launching his new political party, Kiiraay, President Diomaye Faye has strengthened his political machine ahead of local and expected snap legislative elections early next year, increasing the likelihood that he secures a parliamentary majority. Such a majority would restore institutional predictability, facilitate economic stabilization, and open a path to a new IMF program in 2027, likely including an external-debt restructuring. The previous negative trajectory reflected the risk that executive-legislature conflict would block fiscal reform, delay an IMF program, and weaken institutional credibility. That risk remains over the next six months, justifying the still-negative short-term trajectory (see: Upgrading long-term trajectory to neutral as Faye's parliamentary prospects improve , 27 August 2026).

EG geopolitical trends

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The purchasing power parity (PPP)-GDP-weighted average of Eurasia Group's political trajectories remained firmly in improving territory in August, though it eased slightly from peak levels. After an extended improvement period that brought the index to its highest levels in over a year, the modest pullback suggests some cooling in the pace of positive trajectory changes. Despite this softening, the index remains well above zero, reflecting a still broadly constructive political environment.

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Volatility of political stability among the 89 countries tracked by Eurasia Group's GPRI continued to decline in August, extending the persistent downward trend seen over the past year. Recent resilience to shocks has been consistent with less volatile GPRI scores, even as scores have declined from previous levels.

Notable year-on-year shifts in political stability

Highlighted countries are selected based on significant changes in underlying GPRI assessments or relevance to topical issues. The charts compare changes in the four dimensions of the GPRI stability assessments (government, society, security, and economy) over the reported time frame.

Tracking changes in macroeconomic vulnerability and political capacity

Each month, Eurasia Group updates country scores that estimate forward-looking macro vulnerability (risk of welfare loss) and government political capacity (ability to respond to shocks and market pressure). See our methodology [here](#) .

Notable year-on-year movements

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The Czech Republic's political capacity has deteriorated after the 2025 elections replaced a broad center-right coalition with a narrower, more nationalist and euroskeptic ANO–SPD–Motorists coalition. However, it remains one of the strongest democracies in post-communist Central and Eastern Europe. Macroeconomic vulnerability remains stable as the country continues to normalize, with inflation returning to levels last seen before the Iran conflict. Despite slower growth, the economy is still expected to expand at a solid pace, partly supported this year by expansionary fiscal policy.

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Malaysia's political capacity has weakened as Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim's fragile coalition with former rivals has kept the political landscape unstable. Still, Anwar is likely to complete his term, with elections due by early 2028. Macroeconomic vulnerability has also worsened. Although fiscal consolidation remains a central policy goal, weaker political capacity will likely slow progress. Higher populist spending, rising geopolitical tensions, and global market volatility have driven the deterioration, though overall vulnerability remains low, notably on the external side.

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Peru's political capacity has improved following the October 2025 ouster of President Dina Boluarte and the resignation of her cabinet, after years of weak leadership marked by single-digit approval ratings, rising crime, corruption allegations, and protests. Meanwhile, macroeconomic vulnerability has remained largely unchanged. President Keiko Fujimori's administration will likely support investment and policy continuity, while a favorable congress and experienced team should strengthen execution capacity. However, the economic outlook remains exposed to risks from the Iran war and El Niño.

Year-on-year movements

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